Family Mission Checklist:

My Local Government Investigation

Mission 1: The Crossword Warm-Up ~ The Codebreaker

☐ **Decode the Clues:** Read through the crossword puzzle with an adult.

☐ **Fill the Blanks:** Use the Word Bank to find words like
Transparency, Fiduciary Duty, Compliance, and Accountability.

☐ Find 3 words in the puzzle that talk about money or taxes.

_____.

☐ Find 2 words that describe what a good community leader should have.
(**Hint:** look for Integrity, Duty, Compliance, and Accountability).

_____.

_____.

☐ **Define the Big Words:**
Pick 2 words you've never heard before and ask an adult to help you define them.

_____.

☐ Look up what a MUD (Municipal Utility District) stands for. Explain it to a family member.

Mission 2: The Digital Scout ~ Online Super-Sleuth

With the help of a parent, open up a web browser and visit your local district website or search online.

☐ Look up what a WCID (Water Control & Improvement District) stands for. Explain it to family.

☐ **Know Your MUD/WCID:** Is your household served by MUD 1, MUD 2, or MUD 4?
Write it down here: _____.

☐ **Locate the district's website:** Locate the website for the district that serves your household. Write the URL down here: _____.

☐ Find out the name of at least one Board Director for your local Grand Lakes water district. Write the name down here: _____.

☐ **Locate the Budget:** Find the most recent budget summary on the district's website.

☐ **Locate the Financial Report:** Find the most recent financial report on the district's website.

☐ **Track the Income:** Where does the district get its money from?
Hint: Look for “Tax Rate,” “Service Fees,” “Investment,” or “Interest.”

☐ **The “Follow the Money” Challenge:** Find at least one fee paid to a private consultant firm (like an attorney, bookkeeper, auditor, engineer, or tax collector).

☐ Locate the official “Open Records” or “Public Information Act” contact details on the district’s website. Write it down here: _____.

☐ Visit **glwater.github.io** with a parent and read the latest update.

Mission 3: The Deep Dive ~ Take It to School & Community

☐ **The Teacher Chat:** Show the crossword puzzle to your Social Studies, Civics, or History teacher. Ask if your class can do it together!

☐ **The Meeting Mission:** Check the district's website to find the date of the next local Board meeting. Mark it on the family calendar.

☐ **Kitchen Table Debate:** Sit down with your family at dinner and discuss: What is the difference between an honest community servant and someone just working for private interests?

☐ Having looked up the district's annual budget, is it balanced?

What is the revenue? _____.

What are the expenditures? _____.

Is there overspending? Why? _____.

☐ Find out when the next local board election takes place.

Write the date down here: _____.

☐ Work with your family to write a quick email sharing what you discovered and learned during this exercise!

🏆 **Congratulations… Mission Accomplished!**

You are now a Grand Lakes Community Protector…

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